

became master of Corpus Christi College), all his goods, together with his possessions in London, to be disposed of in such manner as they should judge would be most beneficial to his soul. Among the appropriations which they made, were grants to all the colleges then established at Cambridge for an annual commemoration of him.

He married Margaret, the daughter of William Deyncourt, but left no children; his brother, Sir William de Thorpe, being his heir.¹

THORPE, WILLIAM DE.

JUST. C. P. 1342. JUST. K. B. 1345. CH. K. B. 1346. ? B. E. 1352.

To which of the families of Thorpe this William de Thorpe belonged, we have not been able precisely to ascertain. His name appears in the Year Books as an advocate as early as 7 Edward III. In 15 Edward III., 1341, he was made one of the king's serjeants; and is called the king's attorney in the following year. In that year, on April 23, 1342, he was raised to the bench. The words used are "*unus Justiciariorum ad placita in Banco.*"² Dugdale thereupon inserts him among the justices of the Common Pleas; but as he does not mention any fines levied before him, and introduces his name as a justice of the King's Bench in the nineteenth year, on the authority of the liberate Roll, without mentioning the date of his removal from the Common Pleas, it may be doubtful whether his first appointment was not to the King's Bench, especially as he became the chief of it on November 26, 1346, 20 Edward III. In that character he opened the parliaments of the two following years.³

Towards the end of 1350, charges were made against him

¹ Abbrev. Rot. Orig. ii. 337.; Cal. Inquia p. m., 322.; Masters' Hist. of Corp. Christi Coll., Cambridge, 28.; Dugdale's Chron. Series.

² Cal. Rot. Pat. 142.

³ Rot. Parl. ii. 164. 200.